

STUDY MATERIAL

English Language & Comprehension Notes

Demo Edition - SSC - Banking - Railway English

Grammar - Vocabulary - Reading Comprehension

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Table of Contents

About this demo	3
Chapter 1 - Grammar Rules	4
1.1 Tense, articles, prepositions	4
Chapter 2 - Vocabulary	6
2.1 Synonyms, antonyms, idioms	6
Chapter 3 - Reading Comprehension Strategy	8
3.1 Tips, techniques, practice	8
Practice Question Bank (with answers)	10
About StudyElites & How to Get Full Access	12

About this demo

This is a **free demo PDF** from StudyElites. It contains sample chapters from our English Language & Comprehension Notes so you can preview the structure, depth and quality of the full product before purchasing.

The full version (delivered after purchase via Razorpay) contains the complete chapter set, additional practice sets, previous-year question walkthroughs, and topic-wise quick-revision sheets. This demo covers approximately 15-20% of the full material.

What's inside this demo

- Chapter 1 - Grammar Rules (Tense, articles, prepositions)
- Chapter 2 - Vocabulary (Synonyms, antonyms, idioms)
- Chapter 3 - Reading Comprehension Strategy (Tips, techniques, practice)
- Practice question bank with answer key

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Chapter 1

Grammar Rules

1.1 Tense, articles, prepositions

English Grammar is the foundation of the English section across SSC, Banking and Railway exams. Common error spotting questions test: subject-verb agreement, tense consistency, article usage, preposition errors, pronoun-antecedent agreement. Practice 100-150 error-spotting questions to build intuition.

Subject-verb agreement rules: (1) A singular subject takes a singular verb. (2) Two subjects joined by 'and' take a plural verb. (3) Subjects joined by 'or/nor' - verb agrees with the nearer subject. (4) 'Each', 'every', 'everyone', 'nobody' are singular. (5) Collective nouns (team, family) take singular verb when acting as a unit.

1.2 Important Formulas / Rules

Singular subject -> singular verb

Two subjects + 'and' -> plural verb

Two subjects + 'or/nor' -> verb agrees with nearer

'Each', 'every', 'nobody' -> singular

1.3 Worked Example

Example. Spot the error: 'Neither of the boys have completed their homework.'

'Neither' is singular, so verb should be 'has' and pronoun should be 'his' (not 'their'). Correct: 'Neither of the boys has completed his homework.'

Chapter 2

Vocabulary

2.1 Synonyms, antonyms, idioms

Vocabulary questions (synonyms, antonyms, one-word substitutions, idioms & phrases) account for 15-20 marks in SSC CGL English. Building a strong vocabulary requires daily reading + spaced repetition. Master the top 500 high-yield words.

Idioms & phrases are metaphorical expressions whose meaning differs from the literal words. Examples: 'a blessing in disguise' (a good thing hidden as bad), 'break the ice' (start conversation), 'bite the bullet' (endure hardship), 'once in a blue moon' (rarely), 'piece of cake' (very easy).

2.2 Important Formulas / Rules

Synonym: same meaning

Antonym: opposite meaning

One-word substitution: replace phrase with single word

Idiom: figurative expression (not literal)

2.3 Worked Example

Example. What is the synonym of 'ABUNDANT'?

Plentiful. Other synonyms: copious, ample, profuse. Antonyms: scarce, scanty, sparse.

Chapter 3

Reading Comprehension Strategy

3.1 Tips, techniques, practice

Reading Comprehension (RC) accounts for 10-15 marks in SSC and Banking exams. Each passage is 250-400 words with 5-10 questions. Most questions are direct (locate in passage) but some are inferential (read between lines).

5-step RC strategy: (1) Read the first sentence carefully - it sets context. (2) Skim questions first to identify keywords. (3) Scan the passage for those keywords; mark the line. (4) Answer direct questions first, leave inference for last. (5) Never re-read the whole passage - go back only to marked lines.

3.2 Important Formulas / Rules

Step 1: Read first sentence carefully
Step 2: Skim questions for keywords
Step 3: Scan passage for keywords
Step 4: Direct questions first
Step 5: Inference questions last

3.3 Worked Example

Example. What is the best time-saving RC strategy?

Read questions first to identify keywords. Then scan the passage for those keywords (not full read). Mark the relevant lines, then answer direct questions. This saves 2-3 minutes per passage.

Practice Question Bank

10 sample questions with answer key.

Grammar

Q1. Spot the error: 'Neither of the boys have completed their homework.'

- (A) Neither of
- (B) the boys have
- (C) their homework
- (D) have -> has

Answer: (D) - 'have' should be 'has'; 'their' should be 'his'.

Q2. Choose the correct sentence:

- (A) He don't like tea.
- (B) He doesn't likes tea.
- (C) He doesn't like tea.
- (D) He not like tea.

Answer: (C) He doesn't like tea.

Q3. Identify the correct article: '___ honest man is ___ respected citizen.'

- (A) A, a
- (B) An, a
- (C) The, a
- (D) An, the

Answer: (B) An honest man is a respected citizen (honest starts with vowel sound; respected starts with consonant).

Vocabulary

Q4. Synonym of ABUNDANT?

- (A) Scarce
- (B) Plentiful
- (C) Limited
- (D) Few

Answer: (B) Plentiful.

Q5. Antonym of GENEROUS?

- (A) Kind
- (B) Stingy
- (C) Open
- (D) Lavish

Answer: (B) Stingy.

Q6. One-word substitution: 'A person who cannot read or write'

- (A) Illiterate
- (B) Ignorant
- (C) Stupid
- (D) Uneducated

Answer: (A) Illiterate.

Q7. Idiom meaning: 'Bite the bullet'?

- (A) Eat fast
- (B) Endure hardship
- (C) Shoot someone
- (D) Be brave

Answer: (B) Endure hardship.

Comprehension

Q8. Best RC strategy?

- (A) Read passage fully first
- (B) Read questions first, then scan passage
- (C) Skip passage
- (D) Read passage twice

Answer: (B) Read questions first, then scan passage for keywords.

Vocabulary

Q9. Choose the correct spelling:

- (A) Recieve
- (B) Receive
- (C) Receeve
- (D) Receve

Answer: (B) Receive (i before e except after c).

Grammar

Q10. Identify the tense: 'She has been studying for two hours.'

- (A) Present
- (B) Present perfect
- (C) Present perfect continuous
- (D) Past

Answer: (C) Present perfect continuous.

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